

Morgan Voss — paper conservator

What everyone knows

You examined the alleged Poe proof under severe time pressure.

What only you know

At 8:05 p.m. a dry brush lifted loose black particles from letters that should have been iron-gall or period printing ink. You failed to stop the preview. At 8:20 p.m. Quill was alive, angry, and walking toward Crane with your preliminary note. The fibers under the stain include a bright synthetic strand absent from nineteenth-century rag paper.

Your private objective

Disclose enough to prove the composite without allowing Crane to blame your cleaning for every anomaly.

Your opening move

Demand that physical evidence and provenance be tested separately.

Leverage

Bell can date the text; Vale can place the packet; Crane signed your limited examination order.

Boundary

You damaged no load-bearing text. Your lapse is procedural, not the disappearance.